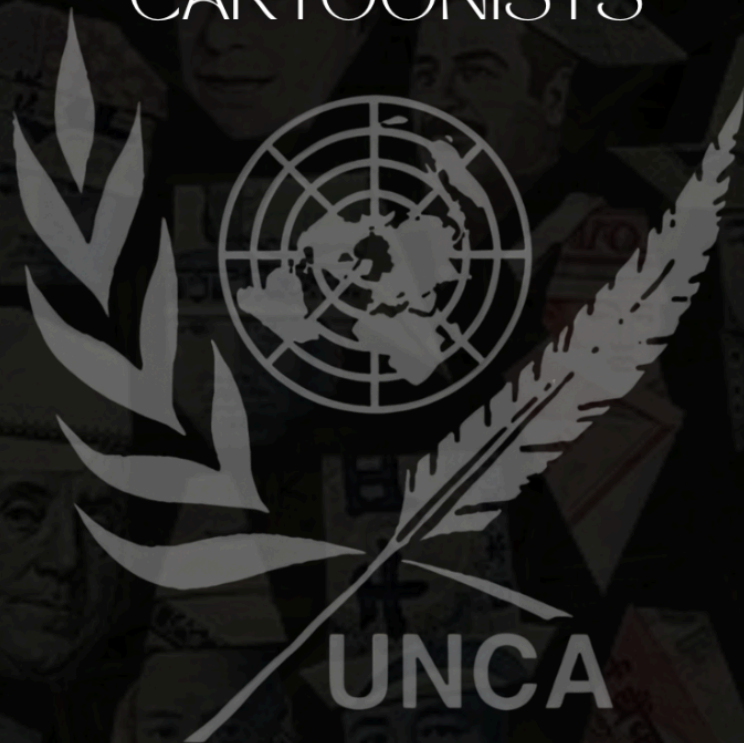




UNITED NATIONS
CORRESPONDENTS ASSOCIATION
CARTOONISTS



PROCEDURE AND
PAPERWORK
GUIDELINES

United Nations Correspondent Association Cartooning

Procedure and Paperwork Guidelines

1. Working of the Committee

At Sanskriti Model United Nations, the United Nations Correspondents Association has crystallised itself as a creative outlet for writers, photographers and cartoonists. The UNCA separates itself from other committees at SMUN by covering its proceedings and debating issues that are highly relevant to the state of media today. Examples of such issues include the safety of the press and cases of erosion of freedom of speech. It is but the perfect platform for developing one's incipient talent as a writer, cartoonist or photographer whilst acknowledging the complications of furnishing the masses with information.

The efforts of the budding delegates from across the three branches- Photography, Journalism, and Cartoonists, will be recognised in the online blog. Based purely on merit, a select few submissions will also be published in the daily newsletter. The newsletter aims to serve as a short-term goal to enhance one's written performance. Evaluating other people's work will also help add another perspective to one's writing.

Every morning, the delegates are required to convene in their respective venues, where they will be briefed on that day's proceedings, their assignments for that session, and the qualitative and quantitative expectations for each assignment. They will be informed of the deadline for every task. Correspondents must meet every deadline, as is the expectation in modern-day press. Delays of any sort won't be looked upon favourably by the Executive Board.

The Committee will be divided between its reporting and debating sessions. For a reporting session, the correspondents decide whether to attend committee proceedings or remain in their respective rooms to complete their tasks. If a delegate chooses to do the former, it must be noted that members of the press are not allowed to interfere with committee procedure. They must simply observe it. However, delegates are permitted and highly encouraged to communicate, question, and clarify issues with delegates using chits. They

may approach the Executive Board if required. Please note that press members are allowed to carry and use electronic devices during the conference. Internet connectivity will, however, only be available in the UNCA room. Usage is only permitted for research purposes. Their usage for anything else will not be looked upon favourably by the Executive Board. The use of tools such as Chat-GPT or AI humanisers or plagiarism will be frowned upon. Delegates are encouraged to uphold journalistic ethics in every action they take during this conference. All lobbying must take place on a platform approved and monitored by the Executive Board. Offensive language is highly prohibited and will lead to a direct disqualification from the awards process. All members of the Executive Board must be added to all WhatsApp groups created with the intention of lobbying.

2. Press Conferences

Press conferences serve as a perfect platform for correspondents to voice questions from the public to those in positions of power, and inculcate a spirit of accountability. It holds corrupt policymakers responsible for their unjust actions. This bestows upon the media the power to shape the viewpoints of billions of people all over the world.

At SMUN, journalists and cartoonists conduct press conferences in the committees allotted to them. The press conference usually lasts for 15-20 minutes, allowing each correspondent to ask 2-3 questions each, excluding the follow-up questions. Before the press conference, delegates are expected to devise questions based on thorough research and observation of committee proceedings. It is advised that one prepares as many questions as possible to avoid any overlap between the questions of fellow correspondents and get them approved by the Executive Board beforehand. The questions can be directed towards an individual delegate, a specific bloc, or the committee at large. If the question is addressed to a specific bloc or the committee at large, it is under the discretion of the UNCA Executive Board to determine who shall answer the question.

Follow-ups are highly encouraged, especially when a delegate fails to provide a satisfactory response to the question posed by the correspondent. They are also reflective of the correspondent's research and understanding of the agenda of their allotted committee. However, pleas to follow up are granted only at the discretion of the Executive Board.

Finally, the key to a successful press conference for a correspondent is confidence and composure alongside the quality of questions posed.

3. Rules of Procedure

A. Roll Call

The committee proceedings begin with a roll call. During the roll call, the Executive Board calls out the names of all news agencies in alphabetical order and the delegates may respond in the following ways:

(i) Present - When delegates respond with 'present', they are given the option to abstain, i.e., neither vote in favour nor vote against a document in substantive voting. Substantive voting relates to voting for draft resolutions and amendments.

(ii) Present and voting - When delegates respond with 'present and voting', they are required to either vote for or against a document in substantive voting. They are not given the option of abstention.

Please note that all delegates are required to vote in procedural matters. No abstinence is granted in procedural votes.

B. Forms of Debate

Formal Debate

Opening statements: In Opening Statements, each delegate, by default, gets 90 seconds to speak. These speeches are used to introduce the agenda, present the news agency's stance on it, highlight problems, and offer solutions.

Provisional Speaker's List: PSL is generally used for debate when the committee is in crisis or to discuss documentation. PSLs are conducted on a specific topic and are exhaustive. The total time of the speech, along with the individual speaker's time, must be specified.

Round Robin: Round Robin is a structured speaking exercise employed primarily at the outset of a session or during key junctures of debate. Under this format, each delegate is accorded equal speaking time in a predetermined order, ensuring that every voice is heard.

Informal Debate

Moderated Caucus: Moderated caucuses are of the utmost importance in a committee as they enable delegates to streamline debate. This allows delegates to debate a specific agenda subtopic within the prescribed time.

Unmoderated Caucus: An unmoderated caucus is an informal debate in which delegates speak directly to one another. Unmoderated caucuses are used to discuss potential moderated caucus topics, complete documentation, and build blocs for lobbying.

C. Motions

A motion is raised when a delegate wants to lead the committee in a specific direction. The following are the types of motions that will be used in committee:

1. Motion to Open Debate This motion is raised to commence debate in the committee. It is raised at the beginning of the first committee session on the first day of the conference. How to raise the motion: “The Delegate of The Hindu would like to raise a motion to open debate.”
2. Motion to open a Provisional Speakers’ List (PSL) The motion to open a PSL is generally used for debate when the committee is in crisis or to discuss documentation. Whilst raising this motion, delegates need to specify the topic, the total time, and the individual speaker’s time. How to raise the motion: “The delegate of the Washington Post would like to raise a motion to open a Provisional Speakers’ List on the topic ‘ABC’ for a total time of 10 minutes, and the individual speaker’s time being 60 seconds.”

3. Motion for a Moderated Caucus. This motion is used when the committee wants to discuss specific subtopics of the agenda. While raising this motion, the topic, total time, and the individual speaker's time must be mentioned. It is important to note that the total time of a moderated caucus must be divisible by the per-speaker time so as to incorporate a whole number of speakers before the moderated caucus elapses. The maximum total time it can be raised for is 20 minutes. How to raise the motion: "The Delegate of Times of India would like to raise a motion for a moderated caucus on the topic 'XYZ' for a total time of 15 minutes, and the individual speaker's time being 60 seconds"

4. Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus During the first few committee sessions, unmoderated caucuses are used to build blocs, converse with other delegates, and discuss potential moderated caucus topics, while in the last few committee sessions, they are primarily used for completing documentation. Just like moderated caucuses, the maximum time an unmoderated caucus can be raised for is 20 minutes. However, unmoderated caucuses do not have a topic or an individual speaker's time. How to raise the motion: "The delegate of Fox News would like to raise a motion for an unmoderated caucus for a total time of 10 minutes"

5. Motion for Extension This motion is used to extend a moderated or unmoderated caucus. It must be kept in mind that they can only be extended by half of the original time they were raised for. If an unmoderated caucus was originally raised for 10 minutes, then for an extension, the motion would be raised by stating: "The delegate of the Agence France Press would like to raise a motion to extend the unmoderated caucus by a total time of 5 minutes"

6. Motion to Discuss a Working Paper/Draft Resolution This motion is used to discuss a Working Paper or Draft Resolution. Delegates may point out loopholes, suggest modifications, and bring up features they feel are relevant while discussing a document to make it more comprehensive, elective, and Implementable.

7. Motion to Close Debate Move into Voting Procedure for a Draft Resolution.

This motion is raised to move into the voting procedure for a draft resolution. A draft resolution requires a special majority comprising 2/3rds of the committee strength in order to pass. Once a draft resolution passes, it is adopted and is considered the final document of the committee, representing the conclusion it has come to.

D. Points

Through points, delegates can ask a question in the committee, clarify their queries, point out procedural errors, inter alia. Points can be categorised as follows:

1. Point of Personal Privilege This point is used when a delegate experiences personal discomfort or inconvenience that hinders their ability to participate in the committee. For example, this point can be used if the delegate wants the Executive board or a fellow delegate to repeat anything. This is the only point that delegates can raise whilst another delegate has the floor in committee.
2. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry This point is used when a delegate needs clarification or has a question about committee procedure. For example, this point can be used if a delegate requires clarification regarding yields.
3. Point of Information This point is used when a delegate wishes to ask another delegate a question after they complete their speech or at any point in the committee. However, verbal Points of Information will only be entertained during the formal debate if the delegate yields to POIs. If a delegate wishes to ask a POI after a moderated caucus speech, they may do so through a chit via the Executive Board.
4. Point of Order This point is used when an error has been committed in the rules of procedure by the Executive Board.

5. Right to Reply A right to reply is used by a delegate to comment or reply when they feel their integrity has been compromised due to personal allegations, insults, or comments made about them. If a Right to Reply is granted, then the delegate will be allowed to speak immediately.

E. Yields

Yields are used when a delegate has time remaining after their speech in formal methods of debate. Delegates may yield their remaining time in the following ways:

1. Yield to the Chair - When a delegate yields to the Chair, their remaining time is dissolved with the committee time.
2. Yield to Points of Information (POIs)- When a delegate yields to points of information, other delegates may ask them questions based on their speech.
3. Yield to Another Delegate- When A delegate yields their time to another delegate, the delegate to whom the remaining time is yielded may comment on the original speech given or further build on it. Delegates are to confer with each other and obtain prior permission before yielding their time to another delegate.
4. Yield to Comments- When a delegate yields to comments, speakers are recognised to make comments regarding the speech for the remaining time.

Delegates are to note that they are not required to yield their time in informal methods of debate.

4. Paperwork

1. Communique

A communiqué is a message that is sent by a delegate to the government of their country or to entities outside the committee, issuing an instruction or a set of instructions in the Committee. A communique, unlike directives, does not have to be written in the UN resolution format and can

be written in simple English; this means that you do not have to use clauses. Communiques allow delegates to solicit help, drive narrative and shape the future committee proceedings.

UNCA Cartooning accepts two forms of communiques: Covert and Overt communiques.

COVERT COMMUNIQUE: A covert communique is a secret or private official communication. Unlike overt messages that are shown to the whole committee, a covert communique exists only for the Executive Board's perusal, often containing sensitive instructions for actions like espionage or other clandestine operations.

OVERT COMMUNIQUE: An overt communique is a public and direct communication. Unlike a covert communique, which is rooted in its illicit nature, an overt one is meant to be seen and drafted by the intended recipients.

A Sample Communique:

PRIVATE COMMUNIQUE

To: ABC

From: XYZ

Contents of the Communique

2. Chits

Chits are short, informal notes passed between delegates during debate to communicate privately. Chits may include questions, ideas, or information about forming alliances.

Chits sent via the Executive Board (EB) are sent through the EB and are marked. They are usually for formal purposes, such as questions to speakers or communication with the chair.

Chits sent not via the EB are informal notes exchanged directly between delegates, typically for lobbying, negotiations, or bloc formation.

3. Press Releases

A Press release is a public statement issued by a delegate, bloc, or committee to inform the public and the delegates about their stance or their actions. The purpose of a Press Release is to inform the public of actions or express condolence, frustration, or condemnation. The goal of a Press Release, aside from informing the public, is also to influence public sentiment.

Press Release Format

AN APPROPRIATE TITLE/HEADING FOR THE STATEMENT BODY OF THE STATEMENT

CONTENT OF THE PRESS RELEASE

SIGNATURES - XYZ, ABC

5. Final Documentation

1. Crisis Cartoon

In addition to covering other crises, cartoonists will also face their own press crisis, where they will be presented with a tense situation requiring immediate action. Members of UNCA are required to be abreast of current trends in politics, economics as well as pressing issues faced in free and fair reporting.

Crisis cartoons will act as resolutions to the committee. These cartoons are developed through collaboration and negotiation among cartoonists, and propose solutions to issues that are discussed during the crisis. They decide which direction the committee goes in which is what makes them such a crucial part of UNCA-C.

2. Joint Action Plan

A Joint Action Plan (JAP) is a formal document that outlines a set of organized and practical solutions to address the agenda under discussion. It is created cooperatively by several delegates in a Model UN committee. It offers workable solutions targeted at a diplomatic and successful resolution of the crisis and represents the collective agreement of the participating nations.

A JAP is usually written in a formal tone with standard phrases like "Calls for," "Encourages," and "Urges," and it contains a list of sponsors and signatories. The document is structured into well-defined clauses that suggest particular actions, from short-term fixes to long-term plans.

Format of a Joint Action Plan:

Committee: (Name of the committee)

Agenda: (Agenda Topic)

Sponsors: News Agency A, News Agency B (The news agencies creating it)

Signatories: News Agency C,
New Agency D (The news agencies wishing to discuss it)

The Committee,

Write 3-4 introductory statements (preambulatory clauses). Start each line with formal words like: **Recalling, Recognising, Alarmed by, Emphasises.** These sentences provide background, explain the significance of the issue, reference past actions or resolutions, and highlight the urgency of the crisis. Preambulatory clauses set the context for the solutions that follow.

Hereby Proposes:

Write the primary solutions in numbered clauses under this section. A formal phrase like **"calls for," "encourages," "recommends," "requests," "supports," or "urges"** should begin each clause. The specific actions or measures that the committee recommends to address the agenda are described in these clauses. Every point should be practical, applicable, and directly related to the problem or crisis. Clarity is ensured by numbering the clauses, and every clause, aside from the final one, which ends with a full stop, usually ends with a semicolon.

Conclusion

At the end of the JAP, you may include a short conclusion summarizing the committee's intent. This paragraph highlights the importance of cooperation, expresses hope for effective resolution, and reinforces the diplomatic and peaceful approach of the plan.

